07-11 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle-School Students Learn a Second Foreign Language?

In our country, English is already a compulsory subject from primary school. But now the question is raised more and more often in parent groups and school meetings: *Should middle-school students learn a second foreign language too — for example, Japanese, French, Spanish, or German?* Some parents feel strongly in favour; others say middle school is already too busy. In my view, **starting a second foreign language in middle school is a wise choice, as long as students learn it in a light, friendly, long-term way**.

The first reason is about the **brain**. Language learning is not only about remembering words; it shapes the way we think. Studies from several countries show that students who learn a second foreign language usually do better in problem solving, memory, and even mathematics. The reason is simple: switching between two language systems forces the brain to choose, to compare, and to organise — all skills that transfer to other subjects. A small effort in French class may come back as clearer thinking in geometry class.

The second reason is **opportunity**. Our world is more connected than ever. Business, tourism, medicine, and technology now cross borders every day. A student who speaks English plus one more language will have **doors** opened to more universities, more scholarships, and more jobs. Many top schools in Asia and Europe give extra points in their entrance test for students with a second foreign language. Even if we never leave our country, reading the news in two languages gives us two windows on the same world.

Some classmates worry: "Middle school is already heavy — adding a language will break me." This worry is serious and deserves a real answer. The key word is **design**. A second language does not need to be studied for three hours every day; fifteen to twenty minutes is enough, if done regularly. A short song on the way to school, a small chapter before bed, a ten-minute conversation with a friend — these build real skill over months, without stealing time from math or science. In fact, many schools in Shanghai now offer second-language classes *after* the main timetable, and students who join those classes report that they feel **refreshed** rather than tired.

Those who oppose a second language sometimes say: "Focus on English first; do not spread the mind thin." This sounds reasonable, but there is a quiet answer. Research shows that starting a second foreign language does not weaken the first. Our brain has

no fixed "language box" that fills up. On the contrary, students who meet another language often **notice** English grammar more clearly, because they have something to compare with. "Thinner" learning is not what happens — "deeper" learning is.

Of course, we must also mention **culture**. Every language carries a culture behind it. A boy who learns Japanese may one day read a poem written 800 years ago. A girl who learns Spanish may meet the warm rhythm of Latin-American music. A student who learns French may, on a winter evening, read a short story about a quiet baker in Paris. These moments will not appear on any exam, but they build a richer human being.

In short, a second foreign language is not just an extra subject. It is a new way of thinking, a new set of doors, a new cultural window. If we choose it wisely, keep it light, and stay with it patiently, middle school will not be harder — it will simply become wider.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main opinion?

A. Middle-school students should learn three foreign languages at the same time.
B. Middle school is too busy; students should not learn any language besides Chinese.
C. Starting a second foreign language in middle school is a wise choice, with light, friendly, long-term learning.
D. Only students planning to go abroad should learn a second foreign language.

2. According to the writer, why is a second foreign language good for the brain?

A. It makes students forget English.
B. It forces the brain to choose, compare and organise, and these skills transfer to other subjects.
C. It keeps the brain small and light.
D. It replaces maths and science.

3. How much daily time does the writer suggest for a second language?

A. Three hours every day.
B. Only on weekends, for four hours at a time.
C. Fifteen to twenty minutes regularly.
D. Ten minutes once a week.

4. What is the writer's answer to "Focus on English first; do not spread the mind thin"?

A. Students should quit English and only study Chinese.
B. Our brain has no fixed "language box"; learning a second language can actually help us notice English grammar more clearly.
C. Only top students should learn English.
D. Schools should pay students to study English.

5. According to the last paragraph, why is culture important?

A. Because every language carries a culture, bringing poems, music and stories that build richer human beings.
B. Because culture is needed for every job.
C. Because culture is a new subject students must memorise.
D. Because culture replaces language learning.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】首段尾句
【解析】应在轻松、长期的方式下学习第二外语。A/B/D 均偏离。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"forces the brain to choose, to compare..."
【解析】切换语言锻炼大脑。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"fifteen to twenty minutes is enough"
【解析】每天 15—20 分钟。A/B/D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】"no fixed language box... notice English grammar more clearly"
【解析】双语反而加强英语意识。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】最后一段
【解析】文化+诗+音乐+故事。B/C/D 均错。故选 A。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **compulsory** [adj.] 必修的
- **switching** [v.–ing] 切换

- **scholarship** [n.] 奖学金
- **refresh** [v.] 使清爽
- **rhythm** [n.] 节奏